MODULE 06

Connection & Confidence

Create a welcoming choir that listens and participates.



A NAME OFFERED → A KIND GROUP ECHO

Name and Note Circle



One Helpful Thing

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Choose one goal. Try one illustrated task. Carry what works into your music.

ACTIVITY 051

Name and Note Circle

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / A circle or seated semicircle.

Learn names while giving everyone a low-pressure first response.



A NAME OFFERED → A KIND GROUP ECHO

An optional name travels into the circle; the whole group echoes it kindly.

1. The director speaks their name over two gentle beats and everyone echoes it.
2. Invite willing singers to offer a spoken name; the group echoes each without judging pitch.
3. Offer an optional one-note sung version, keeping the option to speak or pass.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Everyone is acknowledged, including those who choose not to sing alone.

COMMON TRAP

Calling on an unwilling singer to solo.

MAKE IT WORK

Use name cards and allow a neighbour to introduce someone with permission.

ACTIVITY 052

Partner Welcome Question

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Pairs with an option to stay in a trio.

Build connection before asking for musical cooperation.



"What song do you enjoy? What helps you rehearse?"

ASK | LISTEN | USE ONE IDEA

Share a partner's answer with the group only with permission.

1. Ask partners to share one song they enjoy and one thing that helps them rehearse.
2. After two minutes, invite volunteers to introduce a partner's preference only with permission.
3. Choose one practical suggestion to use during today's rehearsal.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

At least one useful rehearsal preference is heard and acted on.

COMMON TRAP

Sharing a partner's answer without permission.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer written responses or let singers talk with a familiar partner.

ACTIVITY 053

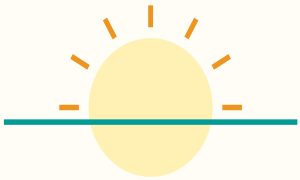
Sound Postcard

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / Small groups of three or four.

Share a musical idea without a solo-performance test.

A ten-second soundscape / one useful role for everyone



VOICE

BODY SOUND

GESTURE

OBSERVER

A quiet ten-second garden soundscape can include a completely silent role.

1

Each group chooses a place such as a garden or station and invents a quiet ten-second soundscape.

2

Give everyone a role: voice, gentle body sound, gesture, or observer.

3

Groups share once while listeners name something they noticed, without scoring the performance.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Every participant has an agreed role and feedback stays descriptive.

COMMON TRAP

Treating the observer role as less valuable.

MAKE IT WORK

Keep all sounds spoken or unpitched and allow complete silence as a role.

ACTIVITY 054

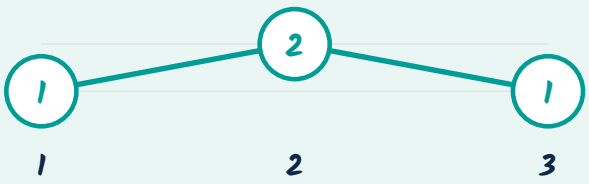
Echo With Consent

Connection & Confidence

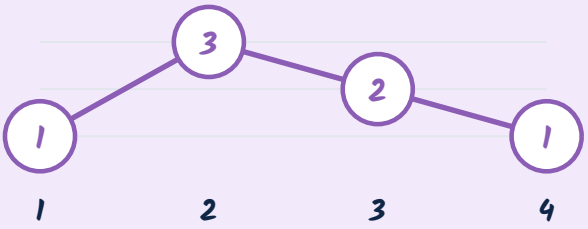
5 minutes / Short three-note model.

Make echo leading inviting rather than compulsory.

OPTION A



OPTION B



Either choice can be useful

A volunteer may sing, point to a pattern, or let the director lead.

1. The director sings a simple pattern and the group echoes together.
2. Invite a volunteer to choose one of two provided patterns to lead, with the director beside them.
3. Thank the leader and return to a full-group response; never call on an unwilling singer.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Volunteers can lead without others being pressured to take a turn.

COMMON TRAP

Calling a volunteer turn compulsory.

MAKE IT WORK

A volunteer may point to a written pattern instead of singing it first.

ACTIVITY 055

One Helpful Thing

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / A brief group performance.

Build useful peer feedback without personal criticism.

FOCUS

Clear final words

OBSERVE

"I noticed the group..."

REPEAT

Keep the useful behaviour

Describe something audible; avoid judgements about someone's voice or talent.

1. Choose one shared focus, such as clear final words, before singing.
2. After the passage, partners describe one specific thing they heard that supported that focus.
3. The choir repeats the passage, keeping the useful behaviour rather than trying to fix everything.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Feedback describes observable musical actions, not talent or personality.

COMMON TRAP

Commenting on talent rather than an audible action.

MAKE IT WORK

Use the sentence 'I noticed the group...' to avoid evaluating an individual voice.

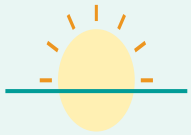
ACTIVITY 056

Common Ground Chorus

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / A board or large sheet of paper.

Discover shared musical interests across the ensemble.



HOPE



REST



BELONGING



CELEBRATION

Choose one theme / make one original shared line

Choose a shared theme, then make a short original chant without asking for private stories.

1. Collect song themes such as hope, celebration, rest, and belonging rather than requiring personal stories.
2. Ask singers to choose one theme they would enjoy communicating together.
3. Speak a short original line about that theme and create a simple group chant.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The choir creates a shared musical idea without requiring private disclosure.

COMMON TRAP

Requiring a personal story to choose a theme.

MAKE IT WORK

Offer prepared themes and permit pointing instead of speaking.

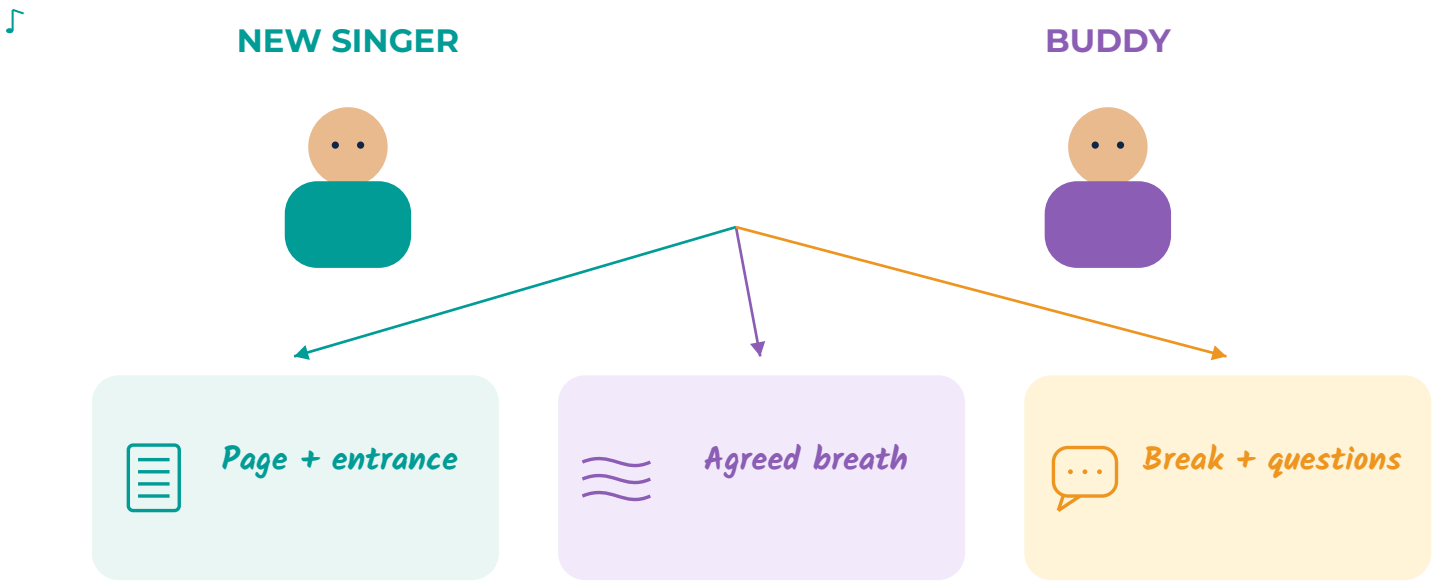
ACTIVITY 057

New Singer Buddy Map

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Score, seating plan, and a willing buddy.

Give a newcomer practical help without testing them publicly.



A useful welcome answers practical questions: where, when, and whom to ask.

1. Pair a newcomer with someone who can quietly explain page numbers, cues, and breaks.
2. Ask the pair to locate the first entrance and one agreed breath together.
3. Rehearse the opening as a full group, then let the newcomer ask a private practical question.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The newcomer knows where to start, whom to ask, and when to take a break.

COMMON TRAP

Testing a newcomer publicly.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a trio or written orientation card if pairing feels uncomfortable.

ACTIVITY 058

Group Signal Agreement

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / Three simple gestures.

Create clear shared signals that reduce uncertainty.

Demonstrate the actual gestures your choir agrees



READY

Prepare together



REPEAT

Do that unit again



STOP

Release + recover

Agree and demonstrate three distinct gestures. Keep their meanings consistent.

1. *Agree signals for ready, repeat, and stop; demonstrate each without sound.*
2. *Practise responding to a mixed sequence of the gestures with silence or a short spoken response.*
3. *Use all three during a real phrase and ask whether any signal was hard to see.*

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Singers can explain and recognize all three signals.

COMMON TRAP

Changing a signal's meaning between rehearsals.

MAKE IT WORK

Pair gestures with words and keep them consistent across rehearsals.

ACTIVITY 059

Small-Win Closing Circle

Connection & Confidence

5 minutes / One passage rehearsed today.

End rehearsal with evidence of progress rather than vague praise.

BEFORE

Scattered final t

TODAY'S CHANGE

One agreed release

NEXT REHEARSAL

Keep that release cue

Record one specific improvement and one practical next step.

1. Sing the chosen passage once and remember the specific focus used earlier.
2. Invite short observations beginning 'Today we improved...' with concrete musical details.
3. Choose one achievement to carry into the next rehearsal and write it on the plan.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group names a verifiable change and a practical next step.

COMMON TRAP

Offering praise with no concrete musical example.

MAKE IT WORK

Use anonymous written notes or a shared group response.

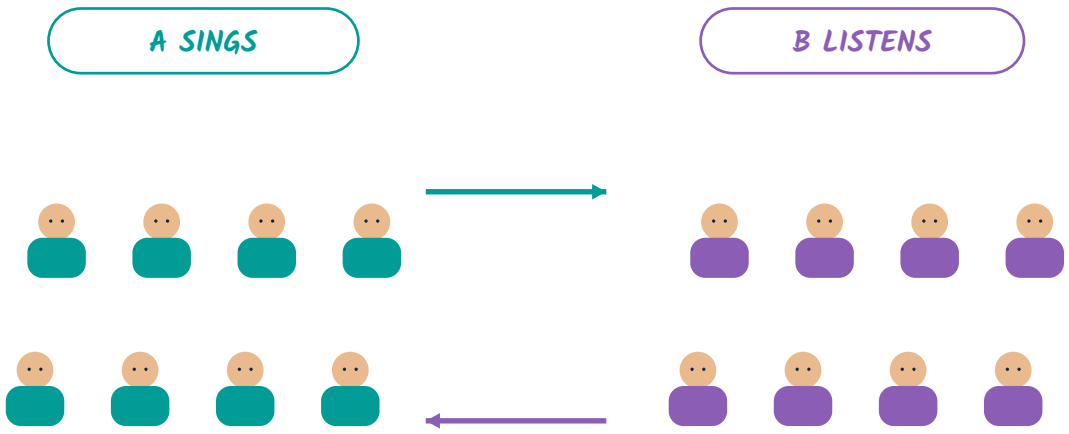
ACTIVITY 060

Listening Seats Exchange

Connection & Confidence

6 minutes / Two groups and a short phrase.

Hear the ensemble from a different perspective without singling out voices.



Swap roles, then sing together

Exchange performer and listener roles. Discuss the ensemble, not individual voices.

1. Group A sings while B listens for one agreed feature, such as aligned endings.
2. B describes what the ensemble did, then the groups exchange roles.
3. Sing together and apply one shared observation; avoid ranking which group sounded better.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

Listening leads to a specific ensemble adjustment rather than comparison between people.

COMMON TRAP

Ranking groups instead of listening for the focus.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a recording only with permission, or let everyone listen to the director's model.